

Modern Communication Skills Suck

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Executive Summary

Communication is a trainable skill that underpins every area of life — money, relationships, confidence — but modern technology is quietly killing daily practice, leaving young people unable to articulate themselves effectively.

Contents

- 🏆 Skills Improve With Practice — Including Communication
- 🌍 Why Communication Is the Foundation of Everything
- ☕ The Canary Wharf Experiment: 40 Minutes, Zero Human Words
- 🎧 The Gym and the Headphone Wall
- 🗣️ What Poor Communication Actually Sounds Like
- 💡 The Marathon Mindset Fix
- 🚫 Where Young People Are "Practising" Instead

Skills Improve With Practice — Including Communication [0:00](#)

- The speaker opens with a personal analogy: he used to have small hamstrings, trained them, and they grew
 - Same principle applied to skipping — started doing it, got good quickly
- Core insight: **whatever you do often, you get good at** — and the inverse is equally true
 - If you rarely practice speaking, you will remain poor at it

Why Communication Is the Foundation of Everything [0:24](#)

- Communication "overlaps into every single thing that we do" — failing at it causes life to "fall drastically"
- Concrete domains where verbal communication is non-negotiable:
 - Attracting a romantic partner — you have to talk to her
 - Selling a product — you have to talk to somebody
 - Money itself — "that's how money is exchanged"
- Key framing: "We don't talk to trees, we don't talk to screens — you talk to humans. You communicate to humans."



The Canary Wharf Experiment: 40 Minutes, Zero Human Words 0:49

- Speaker walked to Black Sheep Coffee in Canary Wharf to get a coffee
 - Approached the counter and spoke naturally: "Yeah, I'll get a coffee, I'll get this, whatever"
 - The barista looked at him "like I had two heads" and said **"Use the screen"** — almost offended that he was speaking to her during her shift
- He then went to a supermarket:
 - Grabbed a few items
 - Paid via a self-service screen — again, no human words exchanged
 - The security guard gave a nod; he nodded back
- Walked home and realised: **40 minutes outside, not a single word spoken to another human being**

"I've been out for like 40 minutes. I've not spoken to a single human being — and that's how bad it is."



The Gym and the Headphone Wall 1:13

- People suggest "go to the gym" as a socialising solution
 - Reality: every single person in the gym is wearing headphones
 - Headphones worn to the gym, during the session, and back home
- Result: "the level of communication now is zero — people aren't communicating"



What Poor Communication Actually Sounds Like 1:37

- Speaker references podcasts featuring young men as evidence
- Example of what he's hearing verbatim: *"well like uh like um yeah like uh well she's bro is just crazy, you know? It's just like it's just it's just blowing my mind. It's crazy. Like the future crazy."*
- His assessment: "You said a lot of nothing. You didn't really communicate anything. You didn't really articulate any words there."
- Specific verbal symptoms:
 - Filler words repeated constantly (like, uh, um, bro)
 - Same words used on repeat
 - Inability to articulate thoughts clearly
 - Poor resonance and vocal quality audible to the speaker



The Marathon Mindset Fix 2:00

- The speaker promotes something he calls **"the marathon mindset"** as the antidote
- He argues it is key to:
 - Confidence

- Effectiveness in life
- Results in social situations
- Results in financial situations
- Being an effective communicator "just helps" across every domain — and it is "a lost art"

Where Young People Are "Practising" Instead 2:23

- Speaker's diagnosis: young people are not getting enough communication practice in this era
- The two main places their "conversations" happen:
 - **Comment sections** — number one source of daily interaction
 - **Gaming consoles with a headset** — talking to someone 200 miles away
- Why these substitutes fall short:
 - They put you behind a screen
 - No eye contact required or developed
 - No awareness of your own body language
 - No control of pacing or vocal delivery
 - Distance and anonymity remove the real social stakes that build skill